

zaanvort

In August every year it's the Dutch Formula One Grand Prix which is held in the beach town of Zandvoort around 20 minutes by train from Amsterdam City Central. I travel to the town by train and experience the beach bar with a very cheeky seagull. So if you are getting on the tram in Amsterdam, make sure you check in and check out with your credit card or debit card.

There's a little green tap as you get onto the tram, so I just checked in and I will check out on the way out. Remember if you do not check out, you will be charged around €4 as opposed to €1.20 if you do check out. If you fail to check in and check out then, or if you fail to check out after you've checked in, you will be charged €4 rather than €1.20 for a trip.

So it's really important that you check out as you leave the tram if you are riding the OVG in Amsterdam. Also get an OV chip card which you can reload and these are about €4 to buy and you can reload them with any amount you like. So if you reload it with €10, you'll get about 8 trips out of that around Central Amsterdam.

So it's a very good way of getting around town. The trams are very clean, very modern and I'm taking the number 17 which takes me to the Ordana area and it takes you past some beautiful places, the canals, up past the Royal Palace, the Rosenkracht and a lot of really fantastic places to see just on the tram. It's a lovely, lovely ride from Amsterdam Central Station if you go into the Ordana which is called course J-O-O-R-D-A-N and you'll see a lot of lovely sights along the way.

So tram in Amsterdam if you don't have a bike is definitely great because you can stop wherever you like, get off wherever you like and they do have a daily cap as well. So if you are riding the tram on multiple occasions, you only pay a certain amount of euros and then after that it's free. I think it's about 7 or 8 euros and then after that the tram doesn't recharge you anymore.

So riding the tram in Amsterdam, a great experience and check it out for yourself if you get in. Jeff Harrison live on the tram on the 17 in Amsterdam for Travel Radio Austria. Well we're on the train now from Amsterdam Central Station to Zandfort MZ which in Dutch means Zandfort on C of course.

And it's a very quick 20 minute ride from Amsterdam Central Station on a beautiful train, usually double deckers with fabulous views. You get very nice views of the countryside and the windmills in the Netherlands. And we're heading to the sea, to the beach resort and of course this week is the Grand Prix event which means that as of Monday of the week all the teams arrive from the Belgian Grand Prix and start setting up the race track at Zandfort.

We're expecting around 100,000 visitors for the Dutch Grand Prix. There's a support staff of about 5 or 10,000 and most of these people are in Amsterdam. So if you are coming around mid-August to Amsterdam be aware that it's very very busy during the week of this particular week because the race starts on the 21st I believe it is.

And the qualifiers are around the 22nd, 23rd and it goes into the weekend with the big final race of course on Sunday. Now Zandfort only recently in the last few years got back onto the Dutch Grand Prix, got back onto the world F1 circuit and they've merely made the most of it. The town really comes alive during Grand Prix week, very very noisy.

But absolutely yes. We're just coming into Sløderdijk now, one of the first stops in Amsterdam. Of course you can actually get the train from Sløderdijk to Zandfort, Amzi as well.

You don't have to get the train from Amsterdam Central but you can grab it here as well. We'll be passing through a couple of really interesting little places called Blumendal which is a very beautiful little town and that is just a 15 minute bike ride or 5 minutes on the train from Zandfort, Amzi. So I'll let you know once we get to town we're going to be looking at all the fabulous places in Zandfort during Grand Prix week and it's going to be very exciting.

Travel news, features and interviews from around the world. This is Travel Radio Australia with your host, Geoff Harrison. Okay, we're just coming into Haarlem now which is a highly recommended city if you are coming to Amsterdam and the Netherlands.

There was one stop before Haarlem called Haarlem-Spann-Walder which we're stopping at now but I would avoid that because it's not the actual Haarlem. It's the satellite town of Haarlem so if you are getting off in Haarlem make sure you get off at the right Haarlem, not the one which is Haarlem-Spann-Walder. So it's very important that you get off at the right stop here.

Now Haarlem is a beautiful, beautiful town. I would highly recommend you go here to Haarlem which is a very nice city indeed. Also, you have to remember to check out when you are coming along on the train.

Yes, just check in and check out with your credit card or you can buy a ticket but you can actually use any credit card to travel on the trains in the Netherlands. You can check in and check out with your credit or debit card which is really, really easy. I have my bike here actually.

I've taken one of my spare bikes from Amsterdam Central and I'm going to leave it here in Zandfort. So when I come on the train I already have a bike waiting for me here so I can cycle around in Zandfort town which is quite small. You don't really need a bike but it's really nice to have one if you want to ride along the sea to a place called Bloomingdale which is just up the road which is really exclusive and lovely little town.

It's nice to have a bike here just waiting for me from Amsterdam. Of course, this week is Grand Prix week and the town is going to be absolutely round with people. Having a bike to get around is really handy as well.

Yeah, Zandfort on Zee which is Zandfort on Zee. We're here to get up to the town which is literally from the train station a one minute walk. So yeah, it's a very nice, easy place to get to

from Amsterdam.

Well, we're sitting on a beautiful table here at Club Teen, Beach Club Teen, that's T-I-E-N where you can grab a free table or a free sunbed and just relax with all the seagulls and the sea and it's beautiful. And the sunset here is really spectacular. This is where a lot of people come from Amsterdam just to chill out, get away from the city.

And as I said, it's only 20 minutes on the train direct to Zandfort on Zee and this week for the parties for the Grand Prix is going to be absolutely magnificent. There's going to be so many people here, 100,000 people descend on Zandfort which is only a little town of about 5,000 people so absolutely huge there. Excuse me, can you just tell me something? How many people in general live in Zandfort? It's on the car.

Yeah, okay. Yeah, I'll just get some information from one of the staff here and it gives a little background of Zandfort itself. So, okay.

Okay, thank you, Val. Okay, perfect. Thank you very much.

Now, here we are. Zandfort has 17,542 inhabitants. The Dutch coastline here is 432 kilometers long and Zandfort has 9 kilometers of beach.

Zandfort has 37 beach clubs. They celebrate Christmas in September here at the beach club team so if you're here in September, it's Christmas time. And I do believe they'll get a visit from the Dutch version of Santa Claus as well.

Inhabitants of Zandfort have the nickname Flounderface so if you live here, that's what they call you Flounderface. Now, the tide goes in and out twice a day and one of the most well-known Dutch songs written in 1915 is all about Zandfort Beach. Now, Zandfort is the only beach town with a train station which was put into service back in 1881.

So, the train that we arrived on has been running regularly here to Zandvoort on Z since 1881. Now, there's a running event here, the Runner's World Zandfort Circuit Run. It's held on the racetrack each year which this week, of course, is the Grand Prix.

The first race on the Zandfort racetrack was held in 1930 so that's a runner's race. Now, the first Formula One race was held here in Zandvoort in 1952. Max Verstappen won the Dutch Grand Prix in September 2021, 2022 and 2023 so let's see if he can win again this time.

It's his home track and he's an expert at it so we're expecting big things from Max Verstappen. Now, Zandvoort was once a spa town where Empress Elizabeth of Sisi stayed, which is why her statue is on the boulevard here at Zandvoort. Now, Beach Club Teen, where I'm sitting at the moment, is sponsored by Air Force, a business from Zandvoort.

And on the last Sunday of September, the Sea Shanty Choir Festival is held on the terrace.

Thank you, Belmonier. Thank you very much.

A very nice café latte has just been delivered to me here. Now, all of the Beach Club Teen is dismantled and taken away. A bloody seagull just came and took my biscuit.

Unbelievable. Ah, well, they're expert at it, I suppose. There's a cycle path all the way from Amsterdam to Zandvoort so you can actually ride your bicycle.

I wouldn't recommend riding a normal bike. I'd get an electric one because it's about 24 kilometers. Now, a train line into Harlem has existed since 1897.

Now, the first Holland Casino in the Netherlands was opened in 1976 here in Zandvoort. Beach Club Teen was voted the best in the province in 2016. And they build the Beach Club in February and take it down in October.

So it's not here all year round, Beach Club Teen. Now, it was fully burned down in the night of the 4th of July 2020. So it had to be rebuilt by borrowing a building from the neighbors' Corrandon Hotels and built up within a month.

Now, Beach Club Teen has more than 400 seats outside and 100 seats inside. And the kitchen is 42 square meters and every meal is prepared fresh from there. Now, they have a separate wine list here.

You can ask the host. So lots of information about Beach Club Teen right in the center of Zandvoort on the beach. And I would highly recommend that you come here and head out.

I wouldn't recommend the seagull who just stole my biscuit. He is a beast. He came out from nowhere and stole my biscuit for my cafe latte.

I mean, that is just unbelievable. Anyway, I hope you don't have that experience while you're here because don't blame it on Beach Club Teen. The seagulls here are vicious.

Keep an eye on your biscuit. Here comes the green flag at the back. We go racing in Zandvoort in five lights time.

And the Dutch Grand Prix is underway. What sort of reaction is it? It's a poor start for Lando Norris and Max Verstappen takes the lead. Once again, Norris has not found the launch he was looking for and the whole hero hits the front of the field.

George Russell is up to third position. It's Verstappen, then Norris and Russell. As the field try to make their way through the first turns on the racetrack for the first time to the inside low line for Biastri.

Can't make it work. It's Verstappen, then Norris and Russell.